EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 8 OCTOBER 2026

Curtis Park, Sacramento

In Curtis Park, El Niño's danger is a healthy tree falling out of waterlogged ground, and the outage that follows: medical devices that stop, generators run indoors, and older people alone for days. The most important step is to reach the 152 residents who depend on powered medical equipment before December, with a battery that works in a storm outage.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Sacramento County, CA (inferred)	None published for the US, California, or the county	n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000	Wind on saturated soil: windthrown trees, multi-day SMUD outages; levee flood is low-probability, high-consequence

13/13 recommendations checked. 1 confirmed, 10 corrected, 1 unverified, 1 contraindicated: a parametric wind policy on the Executive Airport gauge. A second item, relying on the state's utility-shutoff protections, is listed as contraindicated for electricity because they do not bind SMUD. The funding placements were checked separately, and one (motel nights through Loaves & Fishes) is contraindicated because that organisation runs no motel or overnight respite. **The funding target fell 48%**, from $520k to $270k, which is more than the one-third tolerance; $250k of motel nights is held outside the envelope until the County confirms a 2026–27 motel programme and an operator.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



38.55°N 121.48°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** The danger is a healthy tree falling out of waterlogged ground, then the outage: medical devices that stop, generators run indoors, and older people alone for days.
- **First action.** Sacramento County Public Health, SMUD, and Resources for Independent Living reach the 152 residents on powered medical equipment and stock a storm-outage battery pool by 1 December.*
- **The money.** $120k floor, $270k target, about $365k ceiling, set at county scale; the floor starts with $80k of First Step Communities outreach kits.
- **Do not.** Do not assume the state's disaster utility protections cover your electricity this winter: they do not bind SMUD.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for the United States, California, or Sacramento County, and heat is not this place's winter hazard. No population-scaled figure is given here.

Read this first: the trees that kill here are healthy ones, and most are private. In January 2023 an estimated 1,500 trees fell in Sacramento, more than 1,000 of them on private property, and the City's urban forester said most were “healthy, defect-free” trees uprooted from saturated soil. In Curtis Park an 80 ft fir fell on 24th St, a 100 ft-plus cedar on Cutter Way, and a heritage valley oak on 25th St took down a pole and transformer. A City pruning sweep of street trees would mostly miss this failure mode. The county's two storm deaths that month were unhoused people crushed in their tents (Rebekah Rohde on N. 5th St, Steven Sorensen in North Highlands), not in Curtis Park. Inside the neighbourhood, the deaths to plan against will not be recorded as storm deaths: device users, dialysis patients, and people alone in a cold house on day three of an outage.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Actions are ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. The backing lenses are shown on each action, and the RACI chart below assigns each one. One rule underlies every action: trigger on individual wind and atmospheric-river forecasts, not on the season. The strong 2015–16 El Niño under-delivered in Northern California, and the most damaging storms in SMUD's history (December 2022 – January 2023) came in a La Niña winter.

1. Reach the 152 residents on powered medical equipment, enrol them in SMUD's medical rate, and stock a battery pool for storm outages

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MGR | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sacramento County Public Health (emPOWER named list); SMUD (MED enrolment); Resources for Independent Living (battery pool); dialysis units	Named-list request and MED drive in October; batteries by 1 Dec	~$150k for 100 batteries plus case management (see funding); SMUD-funded alternative ~$1.5M countywide	Deaths from failed oxygen concentrators, ventilators, and home dialysis, during multi-day outages

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

HHS emPOWER, re-queried by the verifier on 8 October 2026, counts 4,595 Medicare beneficiaries in ZIP 95818. Of these, 152 use electricity-dependent equipment, including 16 on dialysis, 20 on home oxygen, and 11 in home hospice. Sacramento County has 14,432. SMUD's Medical Equipment Discount (MED) rate is a $15/month credit that needs a clinician's signature; enrolment automatically adds the customer to SMUD's Vulnerable Population Program, which gives extra notice of planned and wildfire outages. Neither SMUD nor PG&E's DDAR programme provides a battery for a storm outage. SMUD's only battery incentive (now up to $6,000) requires rooftop solar and its Solar and Storage Rate, and excludes MED customers; DDAR, which RIL runs for Sacramento and Yolo, is limited to wildfire shutoffs in PG&E territory. The action: request the named list, enrol people in MED on the doorstep, write a plan for outages longer than 24 hours, lend batteries, and ask dialysis units to move sessions earlier before each forecast storm.*

Corrections: the public emPOWER data is de-identified, so “by name” requires the County health department to request the named file through the HHS emPOWER Program. Its sub-counts only include people who also use powered equipment, so 16 understates the ZIP's dialysis patients. MED does not cover CPAP or BiPAP. ZIP 95818 also covers Land Park. Evidence: early dialysis before Hurricane Sandy was associated with 28% lower odds of 30-day death (Lurie et al., *AJKD* 2015, 66:507–512, OR 0.72, 95% CI 0.52–0.997; observational, upper bound near 1). A SMUD-funded battery line is possible as a Rate Stabilization Fund or Community Impact Plan reallocation voted in November, but 1,000 units would arrive in December–January, not by 1 December.

2. On every wind or atmospheric-river warning, move unhoused people out from under trees and off the levees to a confirmed bed, with transport, and record where each person ends up

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City Department of Community Response; First Step Communities (County respite operator); Sacramento Steps Forward	Protocol written by 1 Nov; runs on every warning to 1 Mar	~$120k for kits and warning-day outreach (see funding); bed-nights from existing respite budgets	A repeat of the January 2023 tree-on-tent deaths

The trigger already exists. Since August 2023 the City opens weather respite on an NWS High Wind Watch or Warning, a Wind Advisory, a severe thunderstorm watch or warning, or a 60% or greater chance of rain on two or more consecutive days (1 September to 1 March). The County activated on a 40 mph Wind Advisory in November 2024. In 2024–25 the City's two sites were activated 131 times for more than

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

3,200 bed-nights. What is missing is the move: outreach that reaches the rail-corridor and American River Parkway camps the day before, takes people and their gear to a named bed, and records the destination. Capacity is the limit: about 70 City respite beds against 7,458 people homeless countywide (2026 count), 4,205 of them unsheltered.

Corrections: no camp inside Curtis Park was documented; rail-side camps are reported near W and 20th Streets, and the Parkway is 4–5 km north, so this is a city action Curtis Park can fund and staff rather than a neighbourhood one. The January 2021 deaths were later reported as 5–6, and the coroner said they were not weather-caused. Howe Park held up to 50 people in January 2023; the “200+” were in motels. The claim that a shelter near Rohde's tent had free beds was not verified. After *Grants Pass*, the City can enforce camping law without offering a bed, so the move only holds if it is voluntary and ends at a confirmed bed.

3. Build a storm check-in roster for the 1,512 people aged 65 or over who live alone, through Sierra 2's Senior Center and Curtis Park Court

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sierra Curtis Neighborhood Association (Sierra 2 Senior Center); Domus resident services at Curtis Park Court; block volunteers	**Roster and phone list by 15 Nov**	**Volunteer time; printing**	**Undetected falls, dead devices, cold homes, and CO exposure during outages**

From the 2020–24 ACS for ZCTA 95818 (22,581 people), checked by the verifier: 3,887 residents are aged 65 or over and 1,512 live alone. The Sierra Curtis Neighborhood Association runs Sierra 2 Center at 2791 24th St, says it represents more than 2,500 households, and has a weekday Senior Center (Room 12) and the monthly *Viewpoint*. Curtis Park Court (2315 10th Ave) has 91 units for residents aged 55 and over, with free resident services. Collect phone numbers now, while it is dry, and publish the list's existence on paper, because email does not reach someone whose power and Wi-Fi are out. Volunteers should knock after the wind drops, not during it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no block-captain or check-in programme exists; this has to be built. Sierra 2 has no documented backup power and was not a hub in 2023 (residents drove around to charge phones), so name it only as a paper information point until a generator is confirmed. Transferability: the evidence that social contact protects (Semenza et al., *NEJM* 1996, living alone OR 2.3) comes from the 1995 Chicago heat wave. For winter outages, the case is detection.

4. Check and replace carbon-monoxide alarms, and tell every household: no generator, grill, or gas oven indoors

CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Block volunteers and the Sierra 2 Senior Center; SMUD and PG&E bill inserts	**Before the first atmospheric river; message out by 1 Nov**	**Low; landlords already owe the hardware**	**CO deaths from fuel-burning heat and power used during outages**

California's SB 183 has required CO alarms in homes with gas appliances, a fireplace, or an attached garage since 1 July 2011 (single-family) and 1 January 2013 (other dwellings). Many of those alarms are now at the end of their sensor life. Detectors could have prevented about half of the unintentional CO deaths in a New Mexico series of 136 (Yoon et al., *JAMA* 1998; a modelled estimate). The local case is not storm-related but shows the mechanism: in April 2024 an indoor generator in a south Sacramento apartment left a mother and two children in critical condition.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

No Sacramento Fire Department CO-alarm programme was found, and no Sacramento CO case from the January 2023 storms. Two men died with a generator running indoors at Sea Ranch in the same storm series.

5. Walk the blocks before the soil saturates, report large private trees over homes and lines, and stay off the roads during wind warnings

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Residents (private trees); Public Works Urban Forestry via 311 (city trees); SMUD vegetation management (trees near lines)	Walk and reports in October–November	Volunteer time; private arborist work at owners' cost	Trees through roofs and onto cars, and the line failures behind rank 1

The City maintains more than 100,000 trees; residents own most of the rest, and in 2023 private trees made up more than two-thirds of the failures. In three weeks Urban Forestry logged about 3,000 requests, six months of normal volume. The neighbourhood arborist named saturated-soil windthrow as the main failure mode. Two further cheap rules come from the national record: of 407 US deaths from wind-thrown trees in 1995–2007, 44% were in vehicles and 38% outdoors (Schmidlin, *Natural Hazards* 2009), so stay off the roads and out of rooms beneath big trees during wind warnings.

Corrections: there was no “100 ft tree on 24th St between 4th and 5th Ave”; the trees are as listed above, all private, with no injuries. The City defers non-urgent pruning to the neighbourhood's next routine cycle, so a targeted street-tree sweep by 30 November is unlikely. The SMUD “trees outside the right-of-way” quote (2015) could not be retrieved, and the $500–2,000 per-tree cost is unsourced.

6. Buy flood insurance by 31 October: Curtis Park is levee-protected Zone X, where no lender requires it

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · HISTORIAN | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Households; SCNA *Viewpoint* for the reminder	Buy by 31 Oct for cover from 1 Dec (30-day NFIP wait)	Premiums paid by households; ~$25k outreach if funded	Uninsured ruin if a levee fails; it saves money, not lives

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The verifier queried FEMA's National Flood Hazard Layer at five points in Curtis Park. All return Zone X, “Area with Reduced Flood Risk due to Levee”. That is outside the 100-year zone, so insurance is not lender-required, but the neighbourhood depends on the Sacramento and American River levees. In February 1986 Folsom passed its flood-storage limit and city levees came close to failing, which led to SAFCA's creation in 1989. Sacramento River East Levee erosion work is still being completed in 2026.

Corrections: “Preferred Risk” policies no longer exist under Risk Rating 2.0, though premiums in this zone are low. The 7,497-policy and 63,800-structure figures the lenses cited could not be found in any source and are dropped. Ranked low because it protects households' finances, not lives.

7. Ask the SMUD board for a standing resolution that suspends non-payment shutoffs whenever the City or County proclaims a storm emergency

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SMUD Board of Directors (public comment from SCNA or advocates)	A November board meeting	~$0; deferred collections only	Households losing power for non-payment while recovering from storm losses

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

SMUD's Rule 11 has no weather, disaster, or proclamation clause. The board did suspend non-payment shutoffs by resolution from March 2020 to June 2021, so the mechanism exists. State law already bars disconnecting a customer whose physician certifies that disconnection would be life-threatening, provided they sign a payment plan of up to 12 months (PUC §12823). Enrolling device users in MED under action 1 is the faster protection.

8. Rake leaves off storm-drain inlets before each forecast storm

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Residents, following Department of Utilities guidance; Public Works Recycling & Solid Waste for leaf season	**Within 24 hours of each atmospheric-river forecast**	**None**	**Street ponding where piled leaves block inlets**

Clogged drains were among the most common of the more than 25,000 calls to 311 in the January 2023 storms. Leaf season ran from 3 November to 1 February last year, so it starts when storms do and cannot easily be pulled earlier. The useful action is residents keeping piles out of gutters and clearing the inlet in front of their house.

Correction: leaf collection belongs to Public Works Recycling & Solid Waste, not the Department of Utilities. Ranked last because it protects streets more than lives.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	County Public Health	SMUD	Resources for Independent Living	Dialysis units	City Dept of Community Response	First Step Communities	Sacramento Steps Forward	SCNA / Sierra 2	Curtis Park Court (Domus)	Urban Forestry (Public Works)	Block volunteers & residents	SRCF
1. Power-dependent residents: named list, MED, battery pool, early dialysis	**A**	**R**	**R**	**R**				**C**	**C**		**R**	**C**
2. Warning-day moves to a confirmed bed, with tracking	**I**				**A**	**R**	**R**	**I**				**C**
3. Check-in roster for people aged 65+ living alone	**C**							**A/R**	**R**		**R**	
4. CO alarms; no generators, grills, or ovens indoors	**C**	**R**						**A**	**R**		**R**	
5. Private-tree walk and report; stay off roads in wind		**C**						**A**		**R**	**R**	
6. Flood insurance by 31 Oct								**A**	**I**		**R**	
7. Standing SMUD shutoff suspension on a local proclamation	**C**	**A/R**	**C**					**R**			**I**	
8. Pre-storm drain-inlet clearing								**A**		**C**	**R**	

What the chart shows. **The Sierra Curtis Neighborhood Association is accountable on five of eight rows**, and it has no preparedness programme today, so its willingness is the plan's biggest dependency. **The most important action rests on a data request**: County Public Health has to ask HHS for the named emPOWER file. **Action 2 is a city action**; Curtis Park's role is funding and volunteers, because no camps were documented inside the neighbourhood.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. Amounts are set at county scale, because the organisations that can spend quickly serve the county, not one neighbourhood.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$120k	$270k	~$365k	Whether the County runs a motel programme in 2026–27, which decides whether $250k more can be absorbed

Floor: First Step Communities outreach, 2,000 kits × $40 = $80k plus $40k warning-day outreach = $120k. **Target:** $120k plus Resources for Independent Living $150k (100 batteries × ~$1,200 = $120k, plus $30k case management) = $270k. **Ceiling:** $270k × 1.35 = ~$365k, the extra held as standby released only on an NWS trigger. The target fell 48% in verification, from $520k, because the $250k motel placement named an organisation that runs no motel respite. The $40 kit and $1,200 battery costs are estimates, not quotes; a 1 kWh portable power station retails at about $400–870, so $1,200 buys roughly 2 kWh, enough to run an oxygen concentrator for several hours.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
First Step Communities (EIN 35-2537631; FY2024 revenue $7.97M)	Action 2: survival kits and warning-day outreach to camps under trees	$120k	Restricted grant	2,000 × $40 (estimate) + $40k; already the County's respite operator. Check that wind-day overtime is not already in its County contract	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Resources for Independent Living	Action 1: battery loan pool for storm outages	$150k	Pre-positioned stock, two tranches	100 × ~$1,200 + $30k. Already the region's DDAR centre, so the channel is proven; revenue figure unverified (FY2023 990: $1.19M)	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Sacramento Loaves & Fishes	Overflow motel nights	$0 (was $250k)	n/a	Runs daytime services and a 13-bed women's shelter; no motel vouchers or overnight respite	CONTRAINDICATED
(held outside the envelope)	Motel nights, if the County confirms a 2026–27 programme and operator	$250k contingent	Pledge released on the City's respite trigger	The ~100-room County cap appears only in 2022–23 material; no published nightly rate	UNVERIFIED

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
(none)	Action 5: tree work	$0	n/a	A City and owner duty; low lives saved per philanthropic dollar	CONFIRMED: DO NOT FUND

The funder's one thing: most of this money does more good a mile south. emPOWER, queried the same day for the South Land Park briefing, counts 512 electricity-dependent Medicare users in ZIP 95822, 3.4 times Curtis Park's 152 and at a higher rate (5.6% of beneficiaries against 3.3%). Fund the battery pool citywide with at least half going south, and Curtis Park's exposed minority is covered along the way. And pay for standby, not activation: commit money now as a retainer released on an NWS trigger, and take back what is unspent in April. Nothing in Sacramento is pre-arranged today. The Sacramento Region Disaster Fund raises money after an event and has never pre-committed a triggered release.

DO NOT DO THIS — CONTRAINDICATED

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

Buy parametric wind insurance triggered by gusts of 55 mph at Sacramento Executive Airport

CONTRAINDICATED AS WRITTEN

The Economist proposed a nonprofit-bought policy paying $100–250k into the respite pool. No off-the-shelf California wind parametric product exists for nonprofits; Guy Carpenter's community parametric work (December 2024) is still research, and a custom broker deal could not be bound before the peak. The gauge cleared the threshold twice in about three years (58 kt on 8 January 2023, 53 kt on 4 February 2024), so the premium would be high, and one airport anemometer says little about tree failures in a canopy neighbourhood three miles away.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: put this winter's money into action 1 and a standby pledge on the City's existing respite trigger, which already does what the policy would do.

Assume the state's disaster utility protections cover your electricity this winter

CONTRAINDICATED: THEY DO NOT BIND SMUD

The protections under CPUC D.19-07-015 (no disconnections for non-payment, payment plans) apply only to CPUC-regulated utilities, and only after a Governor's or President's emergency declaration. Here that means PG&E gas. SMUD is a municipal utility, and its own Rule 11 has no disaster clause.

Instead: enrol device users in MED now (action 1), use the physician-certification protection in PUC §12823 where it applies, and press for the standing SMUD resolution in action 7.

Also avoid (lens advice, consistent with verified evidence): clearing camps on the Parkway or levees before a storm without a confirmed bed; the 2022 County bans displace people and nobody has published where they go. Giving away generators, which drive storm CO poisonings. Making sandbags or levee evacuation the headline message in Curtis Park, where the recorded deaths came from trees. And selling this as an “El Niño campaign”: a dry El Niño winter would discredit it, and the next atmospheric river arrives regardless of ENSO. The camp point is supported by the verified ordinance record; the others were not separately verified.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Dec 1861 – Jan 1862	Great Flood: the Sacramento and American rivers meet downtown	~4,000 dead across the West; no city count found	Downtown streets raised 10–15 ft over the following years
Feb 1986	Folsom passes its flood-storage limit; levees come close to failing	13–14 dead statewide; 50,000 evacuated	SAFCA formed (1989); the promised Auburn Dam never built, water rights denied in 2008

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Jan 1997	New Year's floods; Sacramento's levees hold	6–9 dead regionally (lens figure)	Folsom Joint Federal Project spillway, finished October 2017
2015–16	Strong El Niño that under-delivered in Northern California	Near-normal rain (lens figure, not re-verified)	Showed that a forecast El Niño is not a forecast storm
Jan 2021	Storm with warming centres on a 2-day 32°F trigger	5–6 unhoused deaths reported; coroner said not weather-caused	Council added $1M; the City broadened respite criteria to wind and rain in August 2023
Dec 2021	Rainstorm; respite centres closed on the first night	None found	Same criteria review
Dec 2022 – Jan 2023	Atmospheric rivers in a La Niña winter; 8 Jan windstorm	2 unhoused people killed by trees on their tents; ~599,000 SMUD customer outages in total, ~345,000 at peak; ~1,500 trees down citywide	Respite criteria widened (2023); no tree or battery programme for storm outages
Jan 2023, Curtis Park	80 ft fir on 24th St, 100 ft-plus cedar on Cutter Way, valley oak on 25th St	No injuries; homes dark for days	None recorded

The recurrence nobody has noticed: for 160 years Sacramento has spent its flood money on the river, through raised streets, more than $2B via SAFCA, and the dam that was never built. In the most damaging storm series in SMUD's history the river held, and people died under healthy trees on waterlogged ground. That hazard, wind on saturated soil, has recurred in January 2008 and January 2023. No agency owns it, and no budget line covers it. The storms that matter also cluster in the first weeks of January, whatever the ENSO phase.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Sweep camps from under the canopy before storms** (Emergency manager) versus **pause clearances and move people only to a confirmed bed** (Skeptic). The verifier found no documented harm from pre-storm clearances here, but also no data on where displaced people go. The

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

report adopts the Skeptic's condition: voluntary, to a named bed, with tracking.

- **Plan for El Niño** (most lenses) versus **El Niño barely moves Sacramento's odds** (Skeptic, Historian, Public health). The report acts on each wind and atmospheric-river forecast, whatever the season label.
- **Fund batteries through SMUD at ~$1.5M** (Economist) versus **through a nonprofit at $150k** (Philanthropist). Both survive: the nonprofit pool can move this winter, and the SMUD line is the lasting fix.
- **Prune the street trees** (Emergency manager) versus **the failures were private and healthy** (verification). The ranked action shifts to resident reporting and staying off the roads in wind.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens looked at **gas**: an uprooted tree can tear up a PG&E gas service line with its root ball, and nobody checked whether the 2023 storms produced gas leaks in Curtis Park. No lens covered **care homes and assisted-living residences** in 95818, whose backup power duties are set by state licensing, or **Sacramento City College students** beyond a mention of its food-security programme. Smoke from a late-autumn fire elsewhere in the region was also left out.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Seven simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people, and are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named “Curtis Park, Sacramento”. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: Sacramento County, CA, *inferred* rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Most local statistics are for ZIP/ZCTA 95818, which covers Curtis Park *plus* Land Park and

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parts of Upper Land Park, about 22,600 people. Curtis Park is a smaller, older, mostly owner-occupied slice of it.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not this place's winter hazard, so the historical record carries the hazard instead.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, and philanthropist) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted: five lenses converged on street-tree pruning, and verification showed the failures were mostly private and healthy, so that action was re-aimed. Contradictions were kept, including the camp-clearance disagreement. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, given payers or marked unfunded, and reconciled against the funding placements.
- **Verification.** Five separate verifier agents checked 13 recommendations and the funding placements on evidence, transferability, and feasibility. Financial actions were also checked for availability, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they are already implemented. Verifiers queried HHS emPOWER, the FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer, and the Iowa Environmental Mesonet gust archive directly. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted earlier the same day (8 October 2026) by driving the inventory's map interface in a browser for the Elmwood briefing; the US filter returns 19 entries, none covering power-dependent residents, check-in rosters, CO alarms, tree reporting, or camp outreach. It was not re-driven for this location. One verifier could not reach it; another found nothing relevant. Actions are tagged “none found” on that basis.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (oxygen, dialysis, and medical equipment in an outage, and generators and carbon monoxide) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total. Retail and lens cost estimates are labelled as such. No local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. No storm death inside Curtis Park was found, so the death record is county-wide. The 1997 and 2015–16 figures in the record come from the lenses and were not re-verified. Whether SCNA will run a roster, whether Sierra 2 has backup power, the County's 2026–27 motel programme, and RIL's current revenue are all unconfirmed.

References · verified by Phase 5 unless marked. HHS emPOWER REST service (queried 8 Oct 2026) · Census Reporter, ZCTA 95818 (verified) · SMUD Medical Equipment Discount (verified) · SMUD battery incentive (verified) · SMUD Vulnerable Population Program (verified) · PG&E DDAR fact sheet (verified) · Resources for Independent Living, IRS filings (corrected) · Lurie et al. 2015, ASPR TRACIE summary (verified) · Lurie et al. 2015, PubMed (verified) · Semenza et al. 1996 (lens) · County Coroner, January 2023 deaths (verified) · City respite criteria broadened, Aug 2023 (verified) · City weather-respite criteria (verified) · County wind activation, Nov 2024 (verified) · City respite 2024–25 (verified) · County sheltering, Jan 2023 (corrected) · Respite closed first night, Dec 2021 (verified) · January 2021 deaths (corrected) · County camping ordinances, 2022 (verified) · City Grants Pass FAQ (verified) · 2026 point-in-time count (verified) · KFF Health News, hypothermia deaths (verified) · Schmidlin 2009 (verified) · City tree damage, Jan 2023 (verified) · Sierra 2 *Viewpoint*, Feb 2023 (corrected) · Sierra Curtis Neighborhood Association (verified) · Curtis Park Court (verified) · Urban Forestry tree programs (verified) · SMUD storm damage, TDWorld (verified) · SB 183 CO alarm requirements (verified) · Yoon et al., JAMA 1998 (verified) · South Sacramento generator CO case, 2024 (verified) · Leaf season (verified) · 311 calls, Jan 2023 (verified) · FEMA NFHL flood zones (queried) · Sacramento River East Levee work (lens) · SMUD Rule 11 (verified) · SMUD 2020 shutoff suspension (verified) · PUC §12823 (verified) · SMUD 2024 revenue deferral (corrected) · CPUC disaster protections (verified) · Sacramento Region Disaster Fund (verified) · Guy Carpenter parametric research (verified) · First Step Communities, IRS filings (verified) · Sacramento Loaves & Fishes, IRS filings (verified) · Folsom Dam fact sheet (lens) · SAFCA (lens) · Auburn Dam (lens, not re-verified) · USGS, California's large storms (lens)
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory (US)
Generated 8 October 2026 for Curtis Park, Sacramento. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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